CHEN TANG

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley *August 2016 – May 2022*
Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering (Control)
Minors: Machine learning, Optimization
Advisor: Prof. Masayoshi Tomizuka

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology *August 2012 – June 2016*
BEng in Mechanical Engineering
Minor: Mathematics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research interests lie at the intersection of control, robotics, and learning. I aim to develop autonomous robotic systems that operate safely, effectively, and collaboratively in human-centered transportation systems and beyond. My work combines modern AI methods–including deep learning, generative modeling, reinforcement learning, and imitation learning–with control theory, explainable AI, and causality to enable the trustworthy deployment and adaptation of physical AI models on real-world autonomous systems. In the long term, I seek to advance trustworthy, human-centered autonomy and accelerate its integration into everyday life to yield substantial societal benefits.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, UCLA *November 2025 – Present*
Assistant Professor in Transportation Engineering, affiliated with UCLA ITS, the Center of Excellence on New Mobility and Automated Vehicles, and the B. John Garrick Institute for the Risk Sciences

Department of Computer Science, UT Austin *August 2023 – July 2025*
Postdoctoral Fellow (Supervisor: Prof. Peter Stone)

Department of Mechanical Engineering, UC Berkeley *July 2022 – July 2023*
Postdoctoral Scholar (Supervisor: Prof. Masayoshi Tomizuka)

Behavior Team, Waymo *May 2021 – August 2021*
Intern, Planner Prediction Router ML & Deep Learning (Hosts: Qiaojing Yan and Stephane Ross)

Honda Research Institute US *June 2019 – December 2019*
Student Research Intern (Mentor: Sujitha Martin)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Outstanding Paper Award for Resourcefulness in RL, Reinforcement Learning Conference (RLC), 2026
Best Paper Award, ICRA Workshop on RL in the Era of Imitation Learning (RL4IL), 2026
RSS Pioneers, 2023
ASME DSCD Rising Stars Award, 2022
Graduate Division Block Grant Summer, 2020
IEEE ITSC Best Student Paper Runner-up, 2018
HKUST Academic Achievement Medal (top 1%), 2016
HKUST President's Cup Silver Award, 2016
ROBOCON Hong Kong Contest First Runner-up, Best Engineering Award, 2013, 2014
ABU ROBOCON Final Eight, Best Engineering Award, 2013

PUBLICATIONS

*(The superscript * indicates equal contribution.)*

Journal

J1 **Chen Tang***, Ben Abbatematteo*, Jiaheng Hu*, Rohan Chandra, Roberto Martín-Martín, and Peter Stone. Deep reinforcement learning for robotics: A survey of real-world successes. *Annual Review of Control, Robotics, and Autonomous Systems*, 2025

J2 Tommaso Benciolini, **Chen Tang**, Marion Leibold, Catherine Weaver, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Active exploration in iterative gaussian process regression for uncertainty modeling in autonomous racing. *IEEE Transactions on Control Systems Technology (T-CST)*, 2024

J3 Zhiyu Huang, **Chen Tang**, Chen Lv, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Learning online belief prediction for efficient pomdp planning in autonomous driving. *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)*, 2024

J4 **Chen Tang**, Nishan Srishankar, Sujitha Martin, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Grounded relational inference: Domain knowledge-driven explainable autonomous driving. *IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems (T-ITS)*, 2024

J5 Catherine Weaver, **Chen Tang**, Ce Hao, Kenta Kawamoto, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. BeTAIL: Behavior transformer adversarial imitation learning from human racing gameplay. *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)*, 2024

J6 Ce Hao*, Catherine Weaver*, **Chen Tang**, Kenta Kawamoto, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Skill-Critic: Refining learned skills for hierarchical reinforcement learning. *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)*, 2024

J7 Wei-Jer Chang*, **Chen Tang***, Chenran Li, Yeping Hu, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Editing driver character: Socially-controllable behavior generation for interactive traffic simulation. *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)*, 2023

J8 Jinning Li, **Chen Tang**, Wei Zhan, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Hierarchical planning through goal-conditioned offline reinforcement learning. *IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L)*, 2022

J9 **Chen Tang***, Zhuo Xu*, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Disturbance-observer-based tracking controller for neural network driving policy transfer. *IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems (T-ITS)*, 2019

J10 Ángel Cuenca, Wei Zhan, Julián Salt, José Alcaina, **Chen Tang**, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. A remote control strategy for an autonomous vehicle with slow sensor using kalman filtering and dual-rate control. *MDPI Sensors*, 2019

J11 Xu Liu, **Chen Tang**, Xiaohan Du, Shuai Xiong, Siyuan Xi, Yuefeng Liu, Xi Shen, Qingbin Zheng, Zhenyu Wang, Ying Wu, et al. A highly sensitive graphene woven fabric strain sensor for wearable wireless musical instruments. *Materials Horizons*, 2017

Conference Proceedings

C1 Dijie Zhu, Seunghun Oh, Ruopeng Huang, Zhiyu Huang, Jiaqi Ma, and **Chen Tang**. SCAPE: Scenario-conditioned simulation-augmented policy evaluation. *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2026 (Acceptance rate: 33%)

C2 Pengcheng Wang, Kaiwen Hong, Chensheng Peng, Katherine Driggs-Campbell, Masayoshi Tomizuka, Chenfeng Xu, and **Chen Tang**. DiscreteRTC: Discrete diffusion policies are natural asynchronous executors. *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2026 (Acceptance rate: 33%)

C3 Jiaxun Cui, **Chen Tang**, Jarrett Holtz, Janice Nguyen, Alessandro G Allievi, Hang Qiu, and Peter Stone. CoopReflect: Towards natural language communication for cooperative autonomous driving via multi-agent learning. *International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems (AAMAS)*, 2026 (Acceptance rate: 25%)

C4 Zhiyu Huang, Yun Zhang, Johnson Liu, Rui Song, **Chen Tang**, and Jiaqi Ma. TIC-VLA: A thinkin-control vision-language-action model for robot navigation in dynamic environments. *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026 (Acceptance rate: 26.6%)

C5 Jiaheng Hu, Jay Shim, **Chen Tang**, Yoonchang Sung, Bo Liu, Peter Stone, and Roberto Martín-Martín. Simple recipe works: Vision-language-action models are natural continual learners with reinforcement learning. *Reinforcement Learning Conference (RLC)*, 2026 (Acceptance rate: 33.9%)

C6 Michael J. Munje, **Chen Tang**, Shuijing Liu, Zichao Hu, Yifeng Zhu, Jiaxun Cui, Garrett Warnell, Joydeep Biswas, and Peter Stone. SocialNav-SUB: Benchmarking VLMs for scene understanding in social robot navigation. *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2025 (Acceptance rate: 35.77%)

C7 Zichao Hu, **Chen Tang**, Michael Joseph Munje, Yifeng Zhu, Alex Liu, Shuijing Liu, Garrett Warnell, Peter Stone, and Joydeep Biswas. ComposableNav: Instruction-following navigation in dynamic environments via composable diffusion. *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2025 (Acceptance rate: 35.77%)

C8 Yuxin Chen*, **Chen Tang***, Chenran Li, Ran Tian, Peter Stone, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. MEReQ: Max-ent residual-q inverse rl for sample-efficient alignment from human intervention. *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2025 (Acceptance rate: 35.77%)

C9 Yiheng Li, Cunxin Fan, Chongjian Ge, Seth Z. Zhao, Chenran Li, Chenfeng Xu, Huaxiu Yao, Masayoshi Tomizuka, Bolei Zhou, **Chen Tang**, Mingyu Ding, and Wei Zhan. WOMD-Reasoning: A large-scale language dataset for interactions and driving intentions reasoning. *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2025 (Acceptance rate: 26.90%)

C10 Pengcheng Wang*, Chenran Li*, Catherine Weaver, Kenta Kawamoto, Masayoshi Tomizuka, **Chen Tang**, and Wei Zhan. Residual-MPPI: Online policy customization for continuous control. *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2025 (Acceptance rate: 31.24%)

C11 Yiheng Li*, Seth Z. Zhao*, Chenfeng Xu, **Chen Tang**, Chenran Li, Mingyu Ding, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Pre-training on synthetic driving data for trajectory prediction. *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2024 (Acceptance rate: 47.5%)

C12 Yixiao Wang, **Chen Tang**, Lingfeng Sun, Simone Rossi, Yichen Xie, Chensheng Peng, Thomas Hannagan, Stefano Sabatini, Nicola Poerio, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Optimizing diffusion models for joint trajectory prediction and controllable generation. In *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)*, 2024 (Acceptance rate: 27.9%)

C13 Yuxin Chen, **Chen Tang**, Ran Tian, Chenran Li, Jinning Li, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Quantifying interaction level between agents helps cost-efficient generalization in multi-agent reinforcement learning. *Reinforcement Learning Conference (RLC)*, 2024 (Acceptance rate: 40%)

C14 Jinning Li, Xinyi Liu, Banghua Zhu, Jiantao Jiao, Masayoshi Tomizuka, **Chen Tang**, and Wei Zhan. Guided online distillation: Promoting safe reinforcement learning by offline demonstration. *IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)*, 2024 (Acceptance rate: 44.8%)

C15 Yuxin Chen, **Chen Tang**, Ran Tian, Chenran Li, Jinning Li, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Quantifying agent interaction in multi-agent reinforcement learning for cost-efficient generalization. *International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems (AAMAS)*, 2024 (Extended Abstract, Acceptance rate: 45.1%)

C16 Chenran Li*, **Chen Tang***, Haruki Nishimura, Jean Mercat, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Residual q-learning: Offline and online policy customization without value. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2023 (Acceptance rate: 26.1%, featured in **Nikkei Robotics)**

C17 Shaoshu Su, Ce Hao, Catherine Weaver, **Chen Tang**, Wei Zhan, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Double-iterative gaussian process regression for modeling error compensation in autonomous racing. *IFAC World Congress (IFAC)*, 2023

C18 Chenfeng Xu*, Tian Li*, **Chen Tang**, Lingfeng Sun, Kurt Keutzer, Masayoshi Tomizuka, Alireza Fathi, and Wei Zhan. PreTraM: Self-supervised pre-training via connecting trajectory and map. *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)*, 2022 (Acceptance rate: 28%)

C19 **Chen Tang**, Wei Zhan, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Interventional behavior prediction: Avoiding overly confident anticipation in interactive prediction. *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2022 (Acceptance rate: 48%)

C20 Lingfeng Sun*, **Chen Tang***, Yaru Niu, Enna Sachdeva, Chiho Choi, Teruhisa Misu, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Domain knowledge driven pseudo labels for interpretable goal-conditioned interactive trajectory prediction. *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2022 (Acceptance rate: 48%)

C21 **Chen Tang**, Wei Zhan, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Exploring social posterior collapse in variational autoencoder for interaction modeling. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2021 (Acceptance rate: 26%)

C22 Jinning Li, **Chen Tang**, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Dealing with the unknown: Pessimistic offline reinforcement learning. *Annual Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2022 (Acceptance rate: 38.25%)

C23 Julián M. Salt Ducaju, **Chen Tang**, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Application specific system identification for model-based control in self-driving cars. *IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV)*, 2020

C24 **Chen Tang**, Jianyu Chen, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Adaptive probabilistic vehicle trajectory prediction through physically feasible bayesian recurrent neural network. *International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)*, 2019 (Acceptance rate: 44%)

C25 Zhuo Xu, Haonan Chang, **Chen Tang**, Changliu Liu, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Toward modularization of neural network autonomous driving policy using parallel attribute networks. *2019 IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV)*, 2019

C26 Zhuo Xu*, **Chen Tang***, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Zero-shot deep reinforcement learning driving policy transfer for autonomous vehicles based on robust control. *International Conference on Intelligent Transportation Systems (ITSC)*, 2018 (**Best Student Paper Runner-up)**

C27 Jianyu Chen, **Chen Tang**, Long Xin, Shengbo Eben Li, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Continuous decision making for on-road autonomous driving under uncertain and interactive environments. *IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV)*, 2018

C28 Cong Zhao, Rui Xu, Kui Song, Dayu Liu, Shuo Ma, **C. Tang**, Chun Liang, Yitshak Zohar, and Yi-Kuen Lee. The capillary number effect on the capture efficiency of cancer cells on composite microfluidic filtration chips. *IEEE International Conference on Micro Electro Mechanical Systems (MEMS)*, 2015

Workshop

W1 Jiaheng Hu, Jay Shim, **Chen Tang**, Yoonchang Sung, Bo Liu, Peter Stone, and Roberto Martín-Martín. Simple recipe works: Vision-language-action models are natural continual learners with reinforcement learning. *ICRA Workshop on Reinforcement Learning in the Era of Imitation Learning (RL4IL)*, 2026 (**Oral Presentation, Best Paper Award)**

W2 Michael J. Munje, **Chen Tang**, Shuijing Liu, Zichao Hu, Yifeng Zhu, Jiaxun Cui, Garrett Warnell, Joydeep Biswas, and Peter Stone. SocialNav-SUB: Benchmarking VLMs for scene understanding in social robot navigation. *ICRA 2025 Workshop on Advances in Social Robot Navigation: Planning, HRI, and Beyond and ICRA 2025 Workshop on Human-Centered Robot Learning in the Era of Big Data and Large Models*, 2025

W3 Zichao Hu, **Chen Tang**, Michael Joseph Munje, Yifeng Zhu, Alex Liu, Shuijing Liu, Garrett Warnell, Peter Stone, and Joydeep Biswas. ComposableNav: Instruction-following navigation in dynamic environments via composable diffusion. *ICRA 2025 Workshop on Human-Centered Robot Learning in the Era of Big Data and Large Models*, 2025

W4 Jiaxun Cui, **Chen Tang**, Jarrett Holtz, Janice Nguyen, Alessandro G Allievi, Hang Qiu, and Peter Stone. Talking vehicles: Cooperative driving via natural language. *AAAI 2025 Workshop on Advancing LLM-Based Multi-Agent Collaboration*, 2025 (**Oral Presentation)**

W5 Wei-Jer Chang*, **Chen Tang***, Chenran Li, Yeping Hu, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan. Editing driver character: Socially-controllable behavior generation for interactive traffic simulation. *CVPR*

Workshop on Multi-Agent Behavior: Properties, Computation, and Emergence (MABe), 2023

W6 **Chen Tang**, Nishan Srishankar, Sujitha Martin, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Explainable autonomous driving with grounded relational inference. *NeurIPS Workshop on Machine Learning for Autonomous Driving (ML4AD)*, 2020

Preprints and Working Papers

P1 Zikang Xiong, Weixin Li, Zhouchonghao Wu, Akshay Rangesh, Saarth Bonde, Grantland Hall, **Chen Tang**, Yihan Hu, and Wei Zhan. TerraTransfer: Learning end-to-end driving policies without expert demonstrations. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2606.17386*, 2026

P2 Marco Coscoy, Zewei Zhou, Seth Z. Zhao, Henry Wei, Angela Magtoto, Johnson Liu, Rui Song, Walter Zimmer, Zhiyu Huang, **Chen Tang**, Bolei Zhou, and Jiaqi Ma. MDrive: Benchmarking closed-loop cooperative driving for end-to-end multi-agent systems. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2605.10904*, 2026

P3 Ce Hao, **Chen Tang**, Eric Bergkvist, Catherine Weaver, Liting Sun, Wei Zhan, and Masayoshi Tomizuka. Outracing human racers with model-based planning and control for time-trial racing. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2211.09378*, 2022

PATENTS

1. **Chen Tang** and Sujitha Catherine Martin, "Interpretable Autonomous Driving System and Method Thereof," U.S. Patent No. 12,210,965, 2025.
2. Minglei Huang, Jinning Li, **Chen Tang**, Masayoshi Tomizuka, and Wei Zhan, "Pessimistic Offline Reinforcement Learning System and Method," U.S. Patent Application No. 17/969,129, 2024.

GRANTS

Awarded

1. "SAFER-AV: A Simulation-Augmented Framework for Efficient and Reliable AV Evaluation," UC Institute of Transportation Studies (UC ITS) FY 2026–27 Research Program, PI, $100,000, 2026–2027.
2. Tier-2 Sandbox Grant for "CEE 298: Human-Centered Autonomy for Mobility Systems" (Educational Innovation Grants Program), UCLA Teaching and Learning Center, PI, $6,000, 2026.
3. Research Allowance Program, UCLA Academic Senate Council on Research, PI, $5,000, 2026–2027.
4. Research Allowance Program, UCLA Academic Senate Council on Research, PI, $5,000, 2025–2026.

INVITED AND CONTRIBUTED TALKS

Making Physical AI Systems More Deployable

- Toyota Research Institute, 2026
- NVIDIA Research Autonomous Vehicle Research Group, 2026
- Applied Intuition, 2026

Toward Human-Centered Autonomy for Trustworthy Human Interaction

- Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of California, Riverside, 2026

Personalizing Autonomous Driving Control Policies for Individual User Preferences

- ITS Irvine Symposium on Emerging Research in Transportation (ISERT), 2026

Learning and Control for Human-Centered Autonomy

- Intelligent Control Lab, Robotics Institute, Carnegie Mellon University, 2025
- Control and Robotics Lab, Department of Mechanical Engineering, Texas A&M University, 2025
- Control Seminar, Department of Mechanical Engineering, University of California, Berkeley, 2025
- Department of Mechanical Engineering, The University of Texas at Austin, 2025
- Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, University of California, Los Angeles, 2025

- Robotics Engineering Colloquium Speaking Series, Worcester Polytechnic Institute, 2025
- Department of Mechanical Engineering, Colorado State University, 2025
- Department of Intelligent Systems Engineering, Indiana University Bloomington, 2025
- Workshop on The Future of Work in the Age of Robotics and AI at IEEE International Conference on Automation Science and Engineering (CASE), 2025

Customizing Pre-Trained Control Policies for Personalized and Safe Deployment

- Foundation Models for Control (FM4Control): Bridging Language, Vision, and Control at the 5th Modeling, Estimation and Control Conference (MECC), 2025

Towards Trustworthy Human-Centered Autonomy

- Safe AI Lab, Department of Mechanical Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University, 2024
- Mitsubishi Electric Research Laboratories, 2024

Diagnosing Social Interaction Modeling for Interactive Autonomous Driving

- Workshop on Social, Interactive and Safe Behaviors for AVs: Benchmarks, Models, and Applications at IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV), 2023

Designing Explainable Autonomous Driving System for Trustworthy Interaction

- ASME DSCD Rising Stars Invited Talks, 2022
- Robotics: Science and Systems Pioneers Workshop, 2023

Exploring Social Posterior Collapse in VAE for Interaction Modeling

- ASL Lab Seminar, Department of Aeronautics and Astronautics, Stanford University, 2021
- Intelligent Control Lab, Robotics Institute, Carnegie Mellon University, 2021

Zero-shot Deep RL Driving Policy Transfer for Autonomous Vehicles based on Robust Control

- Workshop on Reinforcement Learning for Transportation at IEEE Intelligent Transportation Systems Conference (ITSC), 2018

TEACHING

CEE 298: Human-Centered Autonomy for Mobility Systems *Spring 2026*
Instructor, Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, UCLA
Graduate seminar on the safe, human-aware operation of autonomous mobility systems, covering human behavior modeling and prediction, interaction-aware planning, and human-in-the-loop learning and control.

ME 233: Advanced Control Systems II *Spring 2020*
Graduate Student Instructor, Department of Mechanical Engineering, UC Berkeley
Teaching evaluation: 4.50/5.00 (department average: 4.15/5.00).

Guest Lectures
EE 268: Trustworthy AI for Autonomy, UC Riverside (host: Prof. Jiachen Li), Winter 2026
COMP 790-186: Robot Learning, UNC Chapel Hill (host: Prof. Mingyu Ding), Fall 2025
CS 6501: Multi-Robot Navigation, University of Virginia (host: Prof. Rohan Chandra), Spring 2025

SERVICE AND OUTREACH

Journal Reviewer

- IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L), 2023-2026
- IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering (T-ASE), 2023
- IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems (T-ITS), 2020–2023, 2026
- IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (T-PAMI), 2022-2023, 2025-2026
- Transportation Research: Part C (TR-C), 2024

Conference Reviewer

- AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI), 2023-2026
- American Control Conference (ACC), 2024
- Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR), 2024
- Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2023, 2025
- Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL), 2022-2026
- IEEE International Conference on Control, Automation, Robotics, and Vision (ICARCV), 2018
- IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS), 2022-2023
- IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA), 2021, 2023-2024
- IEEE Intelligent Transportation Systems Conference (ITSC), 2023
- IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV), 2020-2023
- International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2024
- International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2024-2026
- International Joint Conference on Artificial Intelligence (IJCAI), 2024
- Learning for Dynamics and Control (L4DC), 2023
- Modeling, Estimation, and Control Conference (MECC), 2022
- North American Manufacturing Research Conference (NAMRC), 2023
- Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS), 2023-2024, 2026
- World Congress of the International Federation of Automatic Control (IFAC), 2023

Program Committee

- Associate Editor at IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium (IV), 2025-2026
- Associate Editor at IEEE Intelligent Transportation Systems Conference (ITSC), 2021-2026
- Lead Organizer of IEEE ICRA Workshop on Human-Centered Robot Learning in the Era of Big Data and Large Models, 2025
- Lead Organizer of NeurIPS Workshop on Progress and Challenges in Trustworthy Embodied AI, 2022
- Co-organizer of IROS Workshop on Multi-Agent Interaction and Relational Reasoning, 2021
- Co-organizer of IEEE IV Workshop on Development of Socially-Compliant Driving Behaviour for Automated Vehicles to Enhance Safety and Efficiency in Mixed Traffic, 2023
- Program Committee of NeurIPS Workshop on ML for Autonomous Driving (ML4AD), 2022
- Program Committee of NeurIPS Workshop on Robot Learning, 2023
- Program Committee of Symposium on ML for Autonomous Driving, 2023
- Program Committee of ICCV Workshop on Visual Perception for Navigation in Human Environments: The JackRabbot Human Motion Forecasting, 2023
- Program Committee of RSS Pioneers, 2024
- UT Austin Computer Science Ph.D. Admission Committee, 2024

University Service

- Co-Organizer (with Prof. Youngseo Kim and Prof. Jiaqi Ma), UCLA Mobility Seminar Series, 2026
  Co-founded a new seminar series featuring academic and industry leaders in mobility and AI; secured $8,000 in funding from WE@UCLA.
- Reviewer, UCLA Division of Graduate Education (DGE) Privately Endowed Awards, 2026

Student Thesis and Dissertation Committees

- Tianhui Cai, Ph.D. Dissertation Committee Member, UCLA, 2026
- Jungeun Lee, Ph.D. Dissertation Committee Member, UNIST, 2026
- Yanling Sang, M.S. Thesis Committee Member, UCLA, 2025
- Eric Bergkvist, M.S. Thesis Committee Member, EPFL, 2022

Outreach

– Volunteer Mentor, STEM Muse Mentorship Program, 2024

MENTORSHIP

As Faculty (UCLA)

Undergraduate Students

– Jiali Chen (ECE, Spring 2026–present)
– Jonathan Li (MAE, Winter 2026–present)
– Chong Han (Math, Spring 2026–present)

Master's Students

– Dijie Zhu (ECE, Fall 2025–present)
– Rui Gao (ECE, Winter 2026–present)
– Bingan Chen (ECE, Summer 2026–present)

Ph.D. Students

– Seunghun Oh (CEE, incoming Fall 2026)
– Ruopeng Huang (CEE, incoming Fall 2026)

Co-Mentored as Ph.D. Student & Postdoc

Undergraduate Students

– Lu Wen (next: Ph.D. student at the University of Michigan)
– Tianchen Ji (next: Ph.D. student at UIUC)
– Chen Liu (next: Ph.D. student at the University of Cambridge)
– Yiping Dong (next: software engineer at DeepRoute.ai)
– Chenran Li (next: Ph.D. student at UC Berkeley)
– Vade Shah (next: Ph.D. student at UC Santa Barbara)
– Pengcheng Wang (next: Ph.D. student at UC Berkeley)
– Haotian Lin (next: Master's student at CMU)
– Anthony Wang (undergraduate student at UT Austin)

Master's Students

– Julián Salt Ducaju (next: Ph.D. student at Lund University)
– Eric Bergkvist (next: application engineer at Embotech)
– Yaru Niu (next: Ph.D. student at CMU)
– Shaoshu Su (next: Ph.D. student at the University at Buffalo)
– Zhihao Zhao (next: Ph.D. student at UCLA)
– Xinyi Liu (next: Ph.D. student at UNC Chapel Hill)

Ph.D. Students

– Jinning Li (next: Software Engineer at Google)
– Ce Hao (next: Ph.D. student at NUS)
– Catherine Weaver (next: AI Engineer at Atomic Machines)
– Lingfeng Sun (next: Research Scientist at RAI)
– Chenfeng Xu (next: Assistant Professor at UT Austin)
– Yiheng Li (next: Research Scientist at Waymo)
– Chenran Li (next: Research Scientist at NVIDIA)
– Wei-Jer Chang (Ph.D. student at UC Berkeley)
– Yuxin Chen (Ph.D. student at UC Berkeley)
– Yixiao Wang (Ph.D. student at UC Berkeley)
– Michael Munje (Ph.D. student at UT Austin)
– Zichao Hu (Ph.D. student at UT Austin)